code reviews and quality checks to avoid throwing code over the wall to the whole QM team.

Test engineers

For a long time the role of the quality department in software engineering has involved checking to make sure features were implemented to spec. That's not an engineering discipline, and as a result many people in the QA/QM space were not engineers. To truly have an autonomous team, quality engineering has to be a significant part of the team. The role of the quality engineer, a.k.a. QE, a.k.a. SDET, a.k.a. test engineer, has started to become more and more popular. But as quality moves from one state to another in the world of software engineering, this role isn't clearly defined, and often you have either someone with an old quality background who recently learned to write code or you have an expert in testing technology. Neither of these works; you need a senior engineer with a quality mindset. This topic could fill another book, so we'll leave it at that.

Over time, commits and pull requests started increasing as well. As the development team started thinking with a quality mindset, they started writing better code and producing fewer bugs. The combined QM and development teams found and fixed many issues before deploying their code to the test environment.

4.6. Summary

Source control is where your code is being written and reviewed and is a great source to complement PTS data for better insight into how your team is operating. Using the pull request workflow and distributed version control can give you a lot more data than non-distributed SCMs. Often web-based DVCS systems, like GitHub, will have built-in charts and graphs you can use to get a picture of how your team is using them.

- Teams use source control management to manage their codebase.